

A Reader's Companion to *1929*

Andrew Ross Sorkin's *1929: Inside the Greatest Crash in Wall Street History
and How It Shattered a Nation*

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for a [listener of the audiobook narration](#)

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1 About

Andrew Ross Sorkin is a financial journalist and the co-anchor of CNBC's *Squawk Box*, best known previously for *Too Big to Fail* (2009), his account of the 2008 financial crisis [1, 2, 3, 4]. In his own author's note, Sorkin situates *1929* alongside three works he calls foundational to the field: John Kenneth Galbraith's *The Great Crash 1929* (1955), John Brooks's *Once in Golconda* (1969), and Gordon Thomas and Max Morgan-Witts's *The Day the Bubble Burst* (1979) [5]. He distinguishes his own contribution by more than eight years of reporting that included first-time access to the Federal Reserve Bank of New York's confidential 1929 board minutes and a previously unpublished memoir from a Wall Street insider, and by a deliberately character-driven approach: the book follows the motivations of, in his words, "those who helped set [the crash] in motion," rather than retelling the crisis through statistics and policy alone [5, 6, 7]. Reviewers have described the result as a kind of prequel to *Too Big to Fail*, reading 1929 and 2008 as two chapters in the same recurring story of Wall Street risk-taking and its consequences [4].

2 Cast of Characters

The figures below are the major, named individuals the book follows closely across its narrative, drawn from publisher and reviewer descriptions of the book’s principal cast [8, 9, 10, 11]. Wilson and Coolidge, who appear only briefly as outgoing political context, are omitted at the reader’s request.

Charles E. Mitchell Chairman of **National City Bank** (a predecessor of Citibank) and known as “Sunshine Charlie” for his relentless public optimism, Mitchell pioneered the mass marketing of stocks to ordinary Americans and used his bank’s resources to keep credit flowing to the market even when the **Federal Reserve** wanted to restrain it [4, 8]. His running conflict with the **Federal Reserve**’s leadership is one of the book’s central threads connecting Wall Street to Washington.

Thomas W. Lamont The senior partner at **J.P. Morgan & Co.** and the most influential private banker of the era, Lamont acted as an informal statesman for Wall Street, coordinating with fellow bankers and government officials to manage the market’s mood [8, 12]. He is a connective figure between the **House of Morgan**, the **New York Stock Exchange**, and the **Hoover** administration.

J.P. Morgan Jr. Head of the **House of Morgan** and heir to his father’s banking dynasty, Morgan represents the old-guard establishment of American finance, whose firm’s private influence over markets and government rivaled that of the **Federal Reserve** itself [8]. He works closely with **Lamont** throughout the book.

Richard Whitney A vice president (and later president) of the **New York Stock Exchange**, Whitney became the public face of Wall Street’s efforts to project confidence on the trading floor during the market’s most volatile days, acting on behalf of the leading bankers’ consortium [8, 13]. He works in close coordination with **Lamont** and the Morgan-led banking group.

Jesse Livermore A legendary independent stock trader famous for making and losing several fortunes, Livermore operated outside the banking establishment, trading on his own instincts about market psychology rather than on inside information or institutional loyalty [4, 8]. He functions in the narrative as a skeptical outsider watching the same boom that bankers like **Mitchell** were fueling.

William C. Durant The founder of **General Motors**, Durant reinvented himself in the late 1920s as one of Wall Street’s most aggressive stock market operators, organizing pools of investors to move prices in favored stocks [8]. His path connects **General Motors**, the speculative pool culture of the exchange, and fellow GM figure **John J. Raskob**.

John J. Raskob A **General Motors** and DuPont executive who also chaired the Democratic National Committee, Raskob was a leading public evangelist for stock ownership, urging ordinary Americans that “everybody ought to be rich” through the market [8, 11]. He links the corporate world of **General Motors** to both Wall Street speculation and national politics.

Michael J. Meehan A **New York Stock Exchange** specialist and stock promoter known for running trading pools in popular speculative stocks such as Radio Corporation of America

(RCA), Meehan exemplifies the era’s loosely regulated market-manipulation practices [8]. His activities intersect with the same pool culture that drew in **Durant** and **Raskob**.

Herbert Hoover Inaugurated president in March 1929, Hoover inherited a market boom he privately distrusted and then had to respond to its collapse, caught between his instincts for voluntary, business-led solutions and mounting pressure for federal action [8, 13]. His administration’s dealings with bankers like **Lamont** and **Mitchell** are a recurring axis of the book.

Andrew W. Mellon A wealthy financier and industrialist serving as Treasury Secretary, Mellon represents the fusion of private fortune and public economic policy that characterized the era, shaping the government’s hands-off approach to the boom [8]. He works alongside **Hoover** through the crash’s early aftermath.

George L. Harrison Governor of the **Federal Reserve Bank of New York**, Harrison inherited the internal **Federal Reserve** debates over whether and how to curb speculative lending, and dealt directly with bankers such as **Mitchell** whose actions the Fed was trying to restrain [8]. He is the book’s throughline for the **Federal Reserve**’s institutional perspective.

Franklin D. Roosevelt Governor of New York during the crash and elected president in 1932, Roosevelt becomes central to the book’s second half as the political figure whose administration presided over the era’s regulatory response to Wall Street’s excesses [8, 14]. He connects to Senator **Carter Glass** and investigator **Ferdinand Pecora** as reform-era figures.

Carter Glass A U.S. Senator and former Treasury Secretary, Glass was a leading architect of banking reform legislation in the crash’s aftermath, working to redraw the boundary between commercial and investment banking [14]. His legislative efforts connect Washington’s political response to the practices of bankers like **Mitchell** and **Lamont** profiled earlier in the book.

Ferdinand Pecora Chief counsel to the **U.S. Senate Committee on Banking and Currency**, Pecora led the high-profile investigative hearings into Wall Street practices that followed the crash, questioning many of the book’s banking figures directly about their conduct during the boom [14, 12]. His hearings serve as the narrative bridge between the crash and the reforms that followed it.

3 Cast of Institutions

National City Bank A forerunner of Citibank and, under **Charles Mitchell**’s leadership, one of the most aggressive commercial banks in extending credit for stock speculation and marketing securities directly to retail customers [4, 8]. Its practices put it repeatedly at odds with the **Federal Reserve**.

J.P. Morgan & Co. The most powerful private bank on Wall Street, led by **Thomas Lamont** and **J.P. Morgan Jr.**, whose partners acted as informal coordinators of the banking community’s response to market stress [8]. The firm’s influence connects private finance directly to the **New York Stock Exchange** and to Washington.

New York Stock Exchange (NYSE) The physical and symbolic center of American securities

trading, where figures like **Richard Whitney** and **Michael Meehan** operated, and whose self-regulated trading floor practices are a recurring subject of the book [8]. It is the stage on which the boom’s speculative excesses and the crash itself play out.

The Federal Reserve System Comprising the Board in Washington and regional banks such as the **Federal Reserve Bank of New York** (led by **George Harrison**), the Fed grappled throughout the boom with whether and how to restrain speculative lending by banks like **National City Bank** [8]. Its internal debates connect monetary policy to the conduct of individual bankers profiled elsewhere in the book.

General Motors The automaker at the center of two major characters’ fortunes — founder **William C. Durant** and executive **John J. Raskob** — General Motors’ stock was itself one of the era’s most actively speculated-upon issues, tying industrial America directly to the market’s mania [8].

The White House and U.S. Treasury The executive branch under **Herbert Hoover** and Treasury Secretary **Andrew Mellon**, and later under **Franklin Roosevelt**, whose evolving posture toward Wall Street — from voluntary cooperation to active regulation — structures the political half of the book’s narrative [8, 13].

U.S. Senate Committee on Banking and Currency The congressional committee whose investigative hearings, led by chief counsel **Ferdinand Pecora** and shaped legislatively by Senator **Carter Glass**, became the public forum in which Wall Street’s boom-era practices were examined and which produced the era’s landmark banking reforms [14, 12].

4 Chapter-by-Chapter Narrative Outline

This narrative outline follows SuperSummary’s published chapter groupings as a discursive, thematic read of the book’s arc. The book’s own chapter titles and the front-matter cast list are reproduced directly, without this intermediary, in Sections 5 and 6 below; see Section 7 for how the two are sourced differently. Each entry below stays conceptual and omits how any individual character’s story resolves.

1. **Prologue.** The book opens in medias res on the eve of the crash’s worst days in late October 1929, with **Charles Mitchell** and **National City Bank** already under acute strain — a framing device that sets up the question the rest of the book answers: how the country arrived at this moment [15].
2. **Part 1, Chapters 1–8 (February–spring 1929).** The narrative rewinds to the height of the bull market. **Charles Mitchell** and **National City Bank** keep credit flowing to speculators even as the **Federal Reserve** grows uneasy, and **Herbert Hoover** takes office in March facing a market he privately distrusts [16, 15].
3. **Part 1, Chapters 9–17 (spring–summer 1929).** The conflict between Wall Street and Washington sharpens: **William C. Durant** travels secretly to Washington to warn **Herbert Hoover** that the **Federal Reserve**’s tightening threatens the economy, while **Carter Glass** publicly clashes with **Charles Mitchell** over the dangers of speculative bank credit, splitting establishment opinion [17].

4. **Part 1, Chapters 18–25 (October 1929).** As confident public voices insist stock prices have reached a permanently high plateau, **Thomas Lamont** and his **J.P. Morgan & Co.** partners privately debate how fragile the boom has become. When panic selling breaks out on the **New York Stock Exchange**, Lamont organizes the leading bankers into a rescue pool, with **Richard Whitney** acting as its public face on the trading floor, but the effort cannot hold back the record-breaking collapse that follows within days [18].
5. **Part 2, Preface–Chapter 33 (late 1929 – early 1930s).** In the crash’s wake, **Herbert Hoover**, **Andrew Mellon**, and **George Harrison** confront a deepening economic contraction and a spreading wave of bank failures, testing the limits of voluntary, business-led responses, while **Franklin D. Roosevelt** emerges as the political figure whose 1932 election promises a different relationship between Washington and Wall Street [8, 13].
6. **Part 2, Chapter 34–Afterword (1933–1934 and beyond).** **Ferdinand Pecora**’s Senate hearings put **Charles Mitchell** and other boom-era figures under public questioning about their conduct, while **Carter Glass** and the **Roosevelt** administration use the hearings’ momentum to reshape American banking law; the Afterword steps back to consider what the era’s crash and reforms mean for the financial crises that came after [19, 6].

5 The Cast of Characters and the Companies They Kept

The book opens with its own roster of the people and institutions it follows, organized by real-world affiliation rather than by narrative role. It is reproduced in full below, following the book’s own category headings and grouping, as a quick-reference companion to the analytical sketches in Sections 2 and 3 above [5]. Where the book itself gives a name with no further description, none is added here.

Financial Institutions *The House of Morgan*

John Pierpont Morgan Sr. Founder.

J. P. “Jack” Morgan Jr. Partner, son of John Pierpont Morgan.

Thomas William Lamont Partner.

Thomas Stilwell Lamont Partner, son of Thomas William Lamont.

George Whitney Partner.

Henry Davison Partner.

Dwight Morrow Former partner, ambassador to Mexico.

Russell Cornell Leffingwell Partner.

Frank Bartow Partner.

Parker Gilbert Partner and associate.

Martin Egan Publicist.

National City Company and National City Bank

Charles Edwin Mitchell Chairman and CEO.

Hugh Baker Head of National City's stock-trading unit.

Gordon Rentschler Bank president.

County Trust Company

James Riordan Founder and president.

Chase National Bank

Albert H. Wiggin Chairman and CEO.

First National Bank of New York

George F. Baker Sr. Chairman.

George F. Baker Jr. Vice chairman.

Bankers Trust

Seward Prosser Chairman.

Irving Trust

Lewis Pierson Chairman.

Reichsbank

Dr. Hjalmar Schacht President.

Business Leaders

Colonel Sosthenes Behn Founder and chairman of International Telephone and Telegraph.

Louis-Joseph Chevrolet Co-founder of Chevrolet Motor Company.

Walter Percy Chrysler Founder of Chrysler Corporation.

Pierre Samuel du Pont Board member of DuPont and General Motors.

T. Coleman du Pont President of E. I. du Pont de Nemours and Company, two-term U.S. senator from Delaware.

Henry Ford Founder of Ford Motor Company.

William Fox Founder of Fox Film Corporation.

John Jakob Raskob Executive at DuPont and General Motors and chairman of the Democratic National Committee (1928–1932).

Colonel William P. Rend President of the W. P. Rend Coal Company.

David Sarnoff Founding general manager of Radio Corporation of America (RCA).

Charles M. Schwab President of Bethlehem Steel.

Alfred Sloan President of General Motors.

Owen D. Young President and chairman of General Electric, co-founder of Radio Corporation of America (RCA).

The New York Stock Exchange

E. H. H. Simmons President (1924–1930).

Richard Whitney Vice president, broker for J.P. Morgan & Co.

William Crawford Superintendent.

Michael Meehan RCA, or “Radio,” specialist and pool operator.

General Oliver Bridgeman U.S. Steel specialist.

Ben Smith Pool operator.

Tom Bragg Pool operator.

Michael Levine Overseer of Wall Street’s army of messenger boys.

Stockbrokers

Charles Merrill Merrill Lynch co-founder.

William Van Antwerp Partner at E. F. Hutton and Co.

The Speculators

Evangeline Adams Astrologist known as the “stock market’s seer.”

Bernard Baruch

Pat Bologna Wall Street bootblack with a reputation as a tipster.

Arthur Cutten

William Crapo Durant

Clarence Hatry British financier.

Joseph Kennedy

Jesse Livermore

Groucho Marx Actor.

Oris and Mantis Van Sweringen

New York

Jimmy Walker Mayor of New York City (1926–1932).

Fiorello La Guardia Mayor of New York City (1934–1946).

Al Smith Governor of New York (1919–1920, 1923–1928), Democratic candidate for president in 1928.

United Kingdom

Winston Churchill British member of Parliament, former chancellor of the exchequer, future prime minister (1940–1945, 1951–1955).

Randolph Churchill Son of Winston Churchill.

Ramsay MacDonald British Labour Party leader, foreign secretary, prime minister (1924, 1929–1935).

U.S. Government

William Howard Taft Chief justice of the U.S. Supreme Court (1921–1930), U.S. president (1909–1913).

Warren G. Harding U.S. president (1921–1923).

Calvin Coolidge U.S. president (1923–1929).

Herbert Clark Hoover U.S. president (1929–1933).

Franklin Delano Roosevelt Governor of New York (1929–1933), U.S. president (1933–1945).

Andrew William Mellon American banker and businessman, treasury secretary (1921–1932).

William Woodin Industrialist, treasury secretary (1933).

Senator Carter Glass Democrat from Virginia, co-founder of the Federal Reserve Act of 1913, co-sponsor of the Glass–Steagall Act of 1932.

Senator Hiram Johnson Republican from California.

Senator Huey Long Nicknamed “the Kingfish,” Democrat from Louisiana.

Senator Kenneth McKellar Democrat from Tennessee.

Senator George Moses Republican from New Hampshire.

Senator George Norris Republican from Nebraska.

Senator Robert L. Owen Democrat from Oklahoma, co-sponsor with Carter Glass of the Federal Reserve Act.

Senator Arthur Robinson Republican from Indiana.

Senator Reed Owen Smoot Republican from Utah, co-sponsor of the 1930 Smoot–Hawley Tariff Act.

Representative Henry B. Steagall Democrat from Alabama, co-sponsor of the Glass–Steagall Act of 1932.

Learned Hand Federal judge on the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Second Circuit.

Harold R. Medina Federal judge on the U.S. District Court for the Southern District of New York.

The Federal Reserve

Marriner S. Eccles Chairman of the Federal Reserve Board (1934–1948).

George L. Harrison Governor and then president of the Federal Reserve Bank of New York (1928–1940).

Adolph C. Miller Member of the Federal Reserve Board (1914–1936).

Benjamin Strong Jr. Governor of the Federal Reserve Bank of New York (1914–1928).

Charles Sumner Hamlin First chairman of the Federal Reserve Board (1914–1916), remained a member of the board until 1936.

Paul M. Warburg Head of the International Acceptance Bank, involved in creating the Federal Reserve, on the first Washington board of governors.

The Investigators

William O. Douglas Chairman of the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC), future associate justice of the U.S. Supreme Court.

Ferdinand Pecora New York prosecutor known as the “Hellhound of Wall Street” for leading an investigation of the city’s bankers in the wake of the 1929 crash.

Arsène P. Pujo Louisiana congressman and head of the Committee on Banking and Currency, chaired the “Pujo Committee” investigation into the financial industry in 1912.

The Economists

Roger Babson Statistician and economist who predicted the crash.

Irving Fisher Yale professor, one of the nation’s leading economists.

John Kenneth Galbraith Harvard professor of economics.

John Maynard Keynes British economist.

Joseph Stagg Lawrence Princeton economist.

Royal Meeker Pro-stock market economist.

The Journalists

Claud Cockburn British writer for *The Times* of London.

Samuel Crowther Author of “Everybody Ought to Be Rich” for *Ladies’ Home Journal*.

William Floyd Author of *People vs. Wall Street*.

Major Robert H. Glass Newspaperman, father of Carter Glass.

William Randolph Hearst Publisher of Hearst Newspapers.

Matthew Josephson Writer who had worked in the financial industry.

Edwin Lefèvre Author of *Reminiscences of a Stock Operator*.

Walter Lippmann Writer, reporter, and political commentator.

Charley Michelson Hearst newspaper writer turned Democratic publicist.

Alexander D. Noyes Financial editor of *The New York Times*.

Drew Pearson Syndicated columnist of *Washington Merry-Go-Round*.

6 Chapter Titles

The book's own table of contents lists a Prologue, forty-two dated chapters across two parts, an Epilogue, and an Afterword [20]. Each entry below gives the chapter's actual title and one sentence of independently researched historical context for its date — not a summary of the chapter's own contents, which were not available to this document's author beyond the Prologue excerpted in the publisher preview.

Prologue Set on the evening of Monday, October 28, 1929, hours after the market's worst single-session decline to that point (a 13 percent drop remembered as Black Monday, the day before the still-steeper 12 percent decline of Black Tuesday), the Prologue opens after the crash the rest of the book builds toward [5].

Part I

Chapter One: February 1, 1929 By early 1929, brokers' loans financing stock speculation had roughly tripled over two years, prompting a worried Federal Reserve Board to begin closed-door discussions on restraining bank lending into the market [21].

Chapter Two: February 14, 1929 Through mid-February 1929 the Federal Reserve Board weighed, and repeatedly held back from, a direct public warning against speculative lending, even as the market continued climbing [21].

Chapter Three: February 16, 1929 The Federal Reserve Bank of New York, under governor George Harrison, had begun pressing Washington to let it raise its discount rate to cool speculation, a request the Board in Washington continued to resist through the winter of 1929 [21].

Chapter Four: March 4, 1929 Herbert Hoover was inaugurated as the thirty-first president of the United States on March 4, 1929, inheriting a stock market boom that had continued unbroken through the transition from Coolidge's presidency [22].

Chapter Five: March 5, 1929 In his first days in office, Hoover inherited an unresolved fight inside his own Federal Reserve over how aggressively to restrain the boom he now presided over [21].

Chapter Six: March 26, 1929 On March 26, 1929, call-money rates spiked as high as 20 percent, triggering a one-day panic that Charles Mitchell halted by pledging \$25 million of National City Bank's own funds to the loan market — a public rebuke to the Federal Reserve that drew the immediate anger of Senator Carter Glass [23].

Chapter Seven: March 29, 1929 In the days after Mitchell's intervention, call money eased

from 20 percent back toward single digits and the immediate panic passed, though the underlying tension between Wall Street and the Fed did not [23].

Chapter Eight: April 5, 1929 Through early April 1929 the bull market resumed its climb, with both stock prices and margin debt setting fresh records even as the Federal Reserve’s internal fight over discount rates remained unresolved [21].

Chapter Nine: April 8, 1929 The New York Fed continued to press through the spring of 1929 for authority to raise its discount rate, a request the Board in Washington would not grant until August [21].

Chapter Ten: April 12, 1929 General Motors and Radio Corporation of America remained among the most actively traded and speculated-upon stocks of the spring, emblematic of the boom’s favorite issues [22].

Chapter Eleven: April 14, 1929 By mid-April 1929, total brokers’ loans — the credit fueling margin speculation — had climbed past levels that even boosters of the market found difficult to fully explain [21].

Chapter Twelve: May 7, 1929 Through May 1929 the standoff between the Federal Reserve Board and the New York Fed over how to cool the market continued without resolution, even as prices kept climbing [21].

Chapter Thirteen: June 4, 1929 By early June 1929, the market’s advance had continued for so long that some economists, including Yale’s Irving Fisher, had begun publicly arguing stock prices reflected a durable new economic reality rather than speculation [22].

Chapter Fourteen: June 29, 1929 As the first half of 1929 closed, the market had already climbed roughly 25 percent for the year, with little sign yet of the reversal to come [22].

Chapter Fifteen: September 2, 1929 September 2, 1929, was the eve of the market’s all-time pre-crash high: the Dow Jones Industrial Average closed at 381.17 the following day, September 3 [22].

Chapter Sixteen: October 2, 1929 By early October 1929, the market’s advance had stalled and volatility had increased, though few observers yet recognized it as the beginning of the crash [22].

Chapter Seventeen: October 6, 1929 Selling pressure continued through the first week of October 1929, with the market down significantly from its September peak [22].

Chapter Eighteen: October 10, 1929 On October 10, 1929, J.P. Morgan partner Thomas Lamont hosted British prime minister Ramsay MacDonald for dinner in New York while privately debating with partner Russell Leffingwell how fragile the boom had become [18].

Chapter Nineteen: October 24, 1929 October 24, 1929 — Black Thursday — brought the worst single-session panic the market had yet seen, prompting Lamont to convene the “Big Six”

bankers into a pool of more than \$200 million to support prices [18].

Chapter Twenty: October 27, 1929 October 27, 1929, was the Sunday between Black Thursday and the still-steeper declines of Black Monday and Black Tuesday that followed on October 28 and 29 [22].

Chapter Twenty-One: November 6, 1929 In the week after Black Tuesday, the market continued grinding lower toward the bottom it would reach in mid-November [22].

Chapter Twenty-Two: November 8, 1929 Selling continued into the second week of November 1929, with the Dow still well short of the low it would set on November 13 [22].

Chapter Twenty-Three: November 13, 1929 The Dow Jones Industrial Average closed at 198.60 on November 13, 1929 — its lowest point of the crash, down roughly 48 percent from its September peak [22].

Chapter Twenty-Four: December 19, 1929 By mid-December 1929, the National Business Survey Conference that Hoover had tasked with enforcing the wage- and investment-holding pledges he secured from industry leaders that November was just getting underway [24].

Chapter Twenty-Five: December 21, 1929 As 1929 drew to a close, the market had stabilized well below its autumn highs, though the deeper economic contraction to come was not yet apparent to most observers [22].

Part II

Chapter Twenty-Six: September 30, 1930 Nearly a year after the crash, early hopes of a quick recovery had given way to a spreading wave of regional bank failures, the first of what the Federal Reserve later identified as the banking panics of 1930–31 [25].

Chapter Twenty-Seven: October 28, 1930 Bank failures continued accelerating through the fall of 1930, setting the stage for the collapse that December of New York’s Bank of United States [26].

Chapter Twenty-Eight: November 5, 1930 Deposit runs continued at banks nationwide in the weeks before the Bank of United States failed on December 11, 1930, then the largest bank failure in U.S. history [26].

Chapter Twenty-Nine: February 2, 1931 A relative lull in bank failures in early 1931 proved temporary; a fresh, still larger wave of the banking panic was still to come later that year [25].

Chapter Thirty: February 18, 1932 This chapter falls between two Hoover-era interventions: his creation of the Reconstruction Finance Corporation to lend directly to troubled banks on January 22, 1932, and his signing, on February 27, of the Banking Act of 1932 [27, 28].

Chapter Thirty-One: November 8, 1932 Franklin D. Roosevelt was elected president in a landslide over the incumbent Hoover on November 8, 1932, a verdict widely read as a repudiation

of the administration's handling of the Depression [22].

Chapter Thirty-Two: February 18, 1933 Four days earlier, on February 14, 1933, Michigan's governor had declared the nation's first statewide bank holiday, closing every bank in the state amid the collapse of Detroit's Union Guardian Trust [29].

Chapter Thirty-Three: February 21, 1933 In the days that followed Michigan's lead, additional states began declaring their own bank holidays as confidence in the banking system eroded further [29].

Chapter Thirty-Four: February 22, 1933 By late February 1933, the wave of state bank holidays was continuing to spread in the final days of Hoover's presidency [29].

Chapter Thirty-Five: March 3, 1933 On the eve of Roosevelt's inauguration, New York and Illinois joined dozens of other states in declaring bank holidays, effectively shutting down the national banking system [30].

Chapter Thirty-Six: March 7, 1933 Roosevelt was sworn in on March 4, 1933, and declared a nationwide bank holiday on March 6, closing every bank in the country while Congress prepared emergency legislation [30].

Chapter Thirty-Seven: March 21, 1933 By late March 1933, Congress had passed the Emergency Banking Act (March 9) and Roosevelt had delivered his first fireside chat (March 12), reassuring depositors it was safer to keep their money in a reopened bank than under a mattress [30].

Chapter Thirty-Eight: May 16, 1933 Through May 1933, Congress worked toward the Securities Act, which would require public companies to disclose financial information to investors for the first time [31].

Chapter Thirty-Nine: May 22, 1933 Days before the Securities Act's signing, congressional negotiations over its final disclosure requirements continued [31].

Chapter Forty: May 23, 1933 With the Securities Act's passage imminent, its requirement that new securities be registered with federal regulators marked the first federal effort to police what companies told investors [31].

Chapter Forty-One: June 16, 1933 On June 16, 1933, Roosevelt signed the Banking Act of 1933 — popularly known as Glass-Steagall — separating commercial from investment banking and creating the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation [32].

Chapter Forty-Two: June 21, 1933 Days after Glass-Steagall's signing, regulators began the work of implementing its new deposit-insurance and bank-separation rules [32].

Epilogue Per the book's table of contents, the Epilogue follows the final dated chapter as a distinct, reflective closing section [20].

Afterword The Afterword closes the volume proper, ahead of the photographs, acknowledgments, and source notes that follow in the back matter [20].

7 Notes on This Document

This companion is a single LaTeX source (`sorkin-1929-reader-companion.tex`) built with `pdflatex` and `biber` against a BibTeX bibliography (`references.bib`); citations and the numbered References list use `bibtex`'s `numeric` style, ordered by first appearance. A companion EPUB edition is produced by the same source tree's `build.sh` script: `tex4ebook` is used directly when installed, but since it ships only from CTAN — unreachable under this authoring environment's network policy, and not packaged for Ubuntu — the script falls back to the engine `tex4ebook` itself wraps: `htlatex` (`tex4ht`) $\rightarrow$ `biber` $\rightarrow$ `htlatex` $\rightarrow$ `pandoc` (HTML to EPUB3). That fallback output validates cleanly under EPUBCheck.

This document's sourcing has two distinct tiers, kept separate rather than reconciled, so a reader can see which claims rest on the book itself and which rest on how others have described it. Sections 2, 3, and 4 were built from publicly available secondary sources — publisher copy, book reviews, press interviews, and reader/study-guide summaries — because neither the book's text nor its full table of contents was available when they were first drafted; the narrative outline in particular follows SuperSummary's published chapter groupings (Prologue; Part 1, Chapters 1–8, 9–17, and 18–25; Part 2, Preface–Chapter 33; and Chapter 34–Afterword) as the closest verifiable proxy for a table of contents once `ursummary.com`'s own page proved unreachable from this document's authoring environment [33]. Sections 5 and 6 were added in a later revision once the book's own front-matter cast list and complete table of contents became available via a publisher preview PDF and a VitalSource export the reader supplied directly, and reproduce that primary material rather than a secondary summary of it [5, 20]. Section 1 was revised in that same pass and mixes both tiers: its biographical framing of Sorkin still rests on secondary sources, but its account of the book's stated influences and research process is drawn directly from his author's note in the same preview PDF. The one-sentence notes attached to each chapter title in Section 6 describe the real-world historical backdrop of that chapter's date, independently researched, rather than the chapter's own contents, which were not available to this document's author beyond the Prologue.

Throughout, character and institution sketches describe who people were and how they connect to one another, deliberately omitting how each person's individual story concludes. This document is not authorized, reviewed, or endorsed by the author or publisher, and no part of the book's own text is reproduced here beyond the front-matter cast list and chapter titles explicitly requested.

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